IMRAN KHAN'S UPS AND DOWNS

1996
Launches Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI)

2002
Elected to the National Assembly from Mianwali, Punjab

2007
Resigns as parliamentarian along with other politicians in protest at **Gen. Musharraf** contesting presidential polls without relinquishing army chief's post; arrested from rally, briefly jailed



2011
Holds massive rallies in Lahore and Karachi; PTI emerges as a popular party

2013
PTI becomes third-largest party behind PML-N and PPP in general election, forms govt in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP). In tirades against the West and its 'war on terror', Imran deplores attacks on the Pakistani Taliban (Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan), advocating peace talks with them instead

AUG. 2018
Imran takes oath as PM of Pakistan; vows to tackle corruption, repair economy, build an 'Islamic welfare state', reform the tax system and bureaucracy; in televised speech, promises better ties with India

JULY 2018
PTI emerges as single-largest party in general election, wins 155 seats in 342-seat House, forms govt with help from smaller parties like MQM, PML-Q and independent candidates. Imran makes Usman Buzdar of PTI CM of the crucial Punjab province

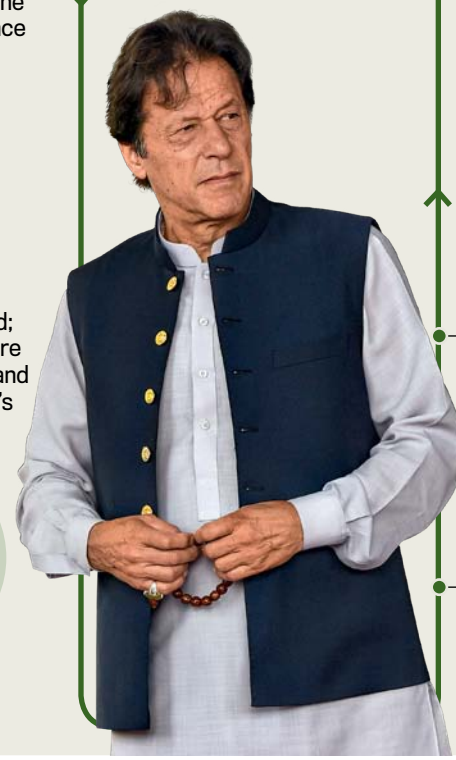
2017
Sharif resigns as PM after Supreme Court disqualifies him from holding office

2014
Alleges PML-N committed electoral fraud; leads rally from Lahore to Islamabad to demand **PM Nawaz Sharif**'s resignation



2018-19
Pakistan's balance of payments and debt crises, already bad before Imran took over, reach critical proportions. In spite of bailout packages worth billions of dollars from Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar and China, the rupee plummets, inflation rises over 10 per cent. Concerns rise over 'mismanagement of economy'

FEB. 2019
Balakot airstrike by India; Pakistani retaliation; Imran decides to release IAF pilot Abhinandan Varthaman



SEPT. 2021
At the UN General Assembly says all Pashtuns living in Pakistan "had sympathy with Afghan Taliban"

AUG. 2021
Taliban enter Kabul, seize power; Imran says Afghans had "broken the shackles of slavery"

JUNE 2020
Global outcry after Imran terms Osama bin Laden a 'martyr'

JULY 2019
US visit, meets President Trump, who calls him "a great athlete and very popular"



JULY 2019
Agreement reached with IMF for a $6 billion bailout package, Pakistan to cut energy subsidy, be on austerity budget to cut fiscal deficit

JUNE 2019
Meets Russian President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

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They had also promised to fix the scourge of corruption within 90 days of coming to power and to improve governance. Here, too, the opposite happened—most businesspeople say the 'rates' of corruption had risen, and Pakistan actually slipped 23 places on Transparency International's Corruption Perceptions Index between 2018 and 2022. Meanwhile, corruption allegations about those closest to Imran, including his wife, are leaking out. The government also botched wheat procurement and LNG deals multiple times, which may yet lead to another food and energy crisis this summer.

In terms of governance, Imran appointed four different finance ministers and the turnover in other positions was often even higher, including five or six heads of the Federal Board of Revenue (FBR). There were such frequent changes in appointments and policy that 'U-turn' has become a running joke in Pakistan, synonymous with Imran Khan. The government's delay in signing on to an IMF programme